

Zahra Daycare Ltd Ltd.



Employees Handbook Policies & Procedures

INDEX

Our Centre-----	4
Who We Are-----	4
Mission Statement-----	4
Day Care Program Philosophy-----	4
Out of School Care Program Philosophy-----	5
Age Appropriateness -----	11
Arrivals, Departures and Transportation-----	7
Child Care Licensing Regulations-----	21
Child Discipline Policy-----	12
Child Drop Off/Pick Up-----	7
Child Guidance & Bullying-----	13
Child/Family Orientation-----	7
Children with Allergies-----	19
Children's Health-----	17
Circle Time-----	10
Computer Usage-----	11
Curriculum-----	9
Daily Routine-----	9
Developmentally Appropriate Practice-----	10
Diapering-----	20
Disinfecting-----	20
Emergency and Safety Contacts and Procedures-----	21
Emergency Closures-----	6
Emergency Situations-----	20
Field Trips-----	10
Fire Drills and Evacuations-----	21
Food and Meals-----	17
Food Handling Policy-----	17
Goals-----	5
Hand Washing-----	20
Health Care-----	18
Holiday Closures-----	6
Hours of Operation-----	6
Illness-----	18
Illness and Medical Procedures-----	18
Incidents and Accidents Reporting-----	11
Inclusion and Diversity-----	9
Individual Appropriateness-----	11
Infant and Toddler Meal Procedures-----	18
Irregular Attendance-----	8
Late Pick up-----	8
Meal Patterns-----	18
Medication Policy-----	19
Off-Site Activity and Emergency Evacuation-----	21
Open Door Policy-----	8

Outdoor Play-----	10
Parent Interaction-----	8
Physical Environment-----	17
Potential Health Risk-----	18

Index Cont.

Program Planning-----	10
Release of Children-----	7
School Closures-----	6
Severe Weather-----	6
Smoking-----	21
Supervised Care for Sick Children-----	19
Supervision Policy-----	15
Technology/Movie Viewing-----	11
Your Classroom-----	9

Personnel policies

Conduct and Ethics-----	25
Confidentiality-----	25
Conflict Resolution-----	34
Disciplinary Process-----	34
Employee Abuse Policy and Procedure-----	31
Employee Benefits & Child Care-----	28
Employee References-----	37
Employment at the Centre-----	25
Equal Opportunity Employer/Non-discrimination Policy-----	24
Evaluation and Advancement-----	29
General Interactions-----	30
Health & Safety Screening-----	27
Illness-----	28
Pay Schedule-----	28
Personnel Records-----	29
Required Staff Meetings-----	30
Review of Policies and Procedures-----	30
Social Media Policy-----	31
Staff Orientation Process-----	25
Staff Screening-----	27
Suspension, Termination, Resignation-----	35
Vacations-----	28
Work Schedule-----	27

Our Centre

Welcome to Zahra Daycare Ltd!

This handbook is designed to help new, current, and prospective employees understand who we are and what our expectations are for our employees. Each section addresses different aspects of Zahra Daycare Ltd and your employment.

Being able to understand who we are and meeting our expectations helps you to embody our commitment to high quality child care and represent the Center in a positive way. Thus, all employees are expected to read this handbook and agree to follow the policies herein.

As with any policy manual, this handbook is subject to amendment as policies change or are added. Management and staff will work together to accomplish this task. Final draft of policies will be available to employees as soon as possible after adoption, either in hardcopy supplements or online at Zahra Daycare Ltd's website at www.mcd daycare.ca

Who We Are

Zahra Daycare Ltd is a family business of Rukhsana Panhwer and Nawaz Panhwer started from scratch in January 2025 to better serve the needs of our families.

The Center's leadership consists of the following individuals and positions: Director: Rukhsana Panhwer
Executive Director: Nawaz Panhwer

In addition, we have a Parent Advisory Committee, whose membership consists of parents, staff and community members who want to contribute their time, ideas, and efforts to help improve Zahra Daycare Ltd for our children. Current membership rosters are available through the Director of the Center.

And last, but certainly not least, there are the teachers like you who have chosen to contribute their talents and expertise to the Center. Without dedicated individuals like you, our Center could not serve the community at large. Welcome to the Zahra Daycare Ltd family!

Mission Statement

Our program focuses on the 'whole child'. Children are respected and accepted unconditionally, regardless of family dynamics, ethnic background or origin, culture, socio-economic status or physical or mental challenges. Our program plan is implemented through the 'learning through play' philosophy. Children learn through direct interaction with others and their environment. Keeping this in mind, it is our intent to offer challenging activities in which children's curiosity and creativity is sparked, ultimately leading to learning.

We believe that childcare should be an extension of the home, supplementing what the child is learning at home. Zahra Daycare Ltd Centre provides a special kind of learning experience focusing on all areas of a child's development: social, emotional, intellectual, physical and creative. We strive, as you do, to encourage children to grow in self-respect, self-control, responsibility and independence.

Daycare Program Philosophy

At Zahra Daycare Ltd Centre our philosophy is based on "Learning through Play ". In order to enhance the children's development as a whole person, we offer a variation of the Montessori program that is more flexible.

Our goal is to provide an environment that will enable the child to develop to his/her optimum potential in all aspects of development. Our qualified staff members facilitate this environment and work to enhance the children's sense of self-respect, self-control, responsibility, and independence. When the child enters in the morning they are greeted by their teachers, at which time they are given the freedom to explore the various learning activities and interest centers that have been prepared beforehand. Dramatic Play Center, Library and Music Center and the Sand/Water Centre etc, are always available and the materials in them are changed daily based on the children's interests. The learning centers are not arranged for ease of movement and convenience of use but rather for maximum challenge to the body and mind. Teachers remain with children at all times engaged in play and extending play and learning. They are always available to answer

questions, offer a challenging statement or make a suggestion in keeping with each child's current level of achievement, interest, ability and needs. The children are given time to explore and experiment, discover, play and to be a child.

Out of School Care Philosophy

At Zahra Daycare Ltd we believe that children are entitled to opportunities that support and encourage their emotional, intellectual, social, cognitive and physical development. We believe that children are important individuals who develop at different rates and in their own ways. We seek to stimulate and develop children's creative thinking and problem solving skills through both staff and child directed activities. We strive to promote a positive self-image for each child by encouraging exploration, fostering the development of social skills and cultivating friendships. We encourage children's involvement in the broader community to help promote a strong sense of community, giving children opportunities to participate in community projects and special events. We believe that children learn through play and personal experiences that foster each child's growth and development. We believe that children's programs should create an environment of trust where friendships are encouraged and each child gains a positive sense of themselves. We support and encourage cooperative partnerships between parents and staff in order to meet all the needs of the children in our care.

The most important goal of our program is to give children a positive sense of themselves. Children are encouraged to try new things, ask questions and express themselves. Our staff members spend a lot of time interacting with the children, continuously making positive comments about children's activities, curiosities and accomplishments. We strive to help children develop confidence, independence and a desire to learn. Our program sets goals for each child in all areas of development:

Social, Emotional, Physical, Cognitive and Creative.

Goals

The following are the basic goals for the children who are in our care:

Emotional:

- to become independent and learn to be in control of their emotions
- to be able to express and deal with the emotions they have
- to learn how others express and deal with emotions
- to develop empathy with others

Social:

- to be able to interact effectively with others, regardless of perceived differences
- to be able to respect others and the property of others
- to be able to function well in a group setting
- to be able to understand why they should cooperate with others
- to be able to develop meaningful friendships

Physical:

- to develop large and small motor skills
- to learn the importance of good nutrition and good hygiene
- to develop lifelong, healthy habits

Intellectual:

- to develop a lifetime love of learning
- to learn observation and discussion skills
- to build a love for reading
- to build upon natural curiosity
- to develop the foundation needed to advance in the primary grades

Hours of Operation

Our hours of operation are Monday to Friday 7:00 am to 6:00 pm. Children may attend for a maximum of 10 hours per day unless individual arrangements are made with the director.

There may be an additional charge for additional staffing if children are attending over the maximum hours per day. We will be closed on all Statutory Holidays and other designated days.

Holidays Closures

Zahra Daycare Ltd will be closed on regular statutory & civic holidays

New Year's Day
Family Day – Alberta
Good Friday
Easter Monday
Victoria Day
Canada Day

Heritage Day – Alberta Labour Day Thanksgiving Day Remembrance Day Christmas Day Boxing Day
--

Generally when one of the listed holidays fall on Saturday or Sunday it will be observed the following Monday

School Closures

Parents are responsible for providing written notification at least one week in advance to Zahra Daycare Ltd of all non-school days, PD days, non-instructional days, holidays, and schedule changes

Severe Weather Conditions

In the event of severe weather conditions, Zahra Daycare Ltd will generally follow the Edmonton School Board in determining whether or not to close the Center. Employees are instructed to listen to local radio and television stations for emergency closing information in these circumstances.

Employees are also instructed to contact the Director or Assistant Director for further instructions. Employees are instructed to contact the Director by 6am and again at 8am for further instructions.

Emergency Closures

Due to severe weather conditions or other emergency situations, there may be times when Zahra Daycare Ltd may be closed. Emergency closing is at the discretion of the Director.

Other situations, including but not limited to electrical power failure, lack of water, lack of heat or air conditioning, hazardous road conditions, or other situations which could endanger the safety or health of children and employees, may result in Zahra Daycare Ltd being closed at the sole discretion of the Director. Employees will be advised of their obligations in these situations.

In the event of an emergency closing in the middle of the day, the Director or Assistant Director will instruct employees during the emergency. Employees are required to remain at the Center as long as there are children present. In rare instances, this may require employees to remain after normal closing hours. Employees must be mindful that compliance with Licensing Regulations must be maintained even in emergency situations (ratios, general policies, and the like). The Director/Assistant Director will inform employees when they are able to go home. Employees who refuse to cooperate during an emergency closing situation may be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination.

Arrival and Departures

Upon arriving at the centre, we ask that parents accompany their child to their room. Parents are to help their child get ready for their day and inform staff of their arrival. Parents must also sign in their child's arrival time in the attendance record book and are encouraged to say goodbye to their child before leaving the centre. If a child is to be absent, we would appreciate that the Director is informed by 9:30 am. At the end of the day, parents must mark their departure time in the attendance record book and inform the teacher of the child's departure.

Release of Children

Children will only be released to persons identified on the authorized pick up list. We ask that the Director is informed in writing or by phone if someone other than the parents will be picking up a child. If we are meeting that person for the first time, a photo ID will be required. We will not release a child to an adult who is intoxicated or under the influence of non-medical drugs. Alternate arrangements will be made by staff to ensure safety of the child at the parent's expense. Please ensure that parents and their child walk out together. Children may not run ahead into the parking lot unattended. Zahra Daycare Ltd Centre will provide transportation to and from schools and transportation is a component of our program (temporary). Prior to registering, Parents should check with the child's school regarding their transportation policy as well.

Child and Family Orientation

Parents are invited and encouraged to bring their child for a visit during the week prior to their first day. This gives them an opportunity to become familiar with the centre, staff and to meet the other children in the program. Parents are required to remain with their child during this visit, as they are not yet registered in our program. During the initial period of adjustment, tears are a very natural occurrence for younger children. Staff have specialized skills to help your child over a difficult time and can assist you both as you say good-bye.

Child Drop Off and Pick Up

Staff, please be prepared when parents drop off children and pick them up. The following procedures are designed to ensure a certain level of interaction each day with our families and promote a consistent process for parents, children, and employees.

Drop off: When a child is dropped off at the Center, please do the following:

- Greet the family by their names upon their arrival.
- For families who receive Child Care Connections assistance, remind the parent to clock in properly.
- Each day a basic health check should be conducted on each child upon arrival, noting any fever, bumps, bruises, burns, and other signs and symptoms of ill health. Questions and comments about anything noted should be addressed to the parent or child in a non-threatening way. Any questionable marks or responses should be documented in writing and submitted to the Director.
- Obtain information that will help you care for the child; e.g., 'When is the last time he had a bottle?' 'How did she sleep last night?' 'Did you have fun with whatever activity you planned yesterday?'
- Help the child say goodbye and get the child involved in an activity.
- Be sure to mark down that the child has attended that day, and make notes for the afternoon teacher about the child if needed.
- If the child has any medications, these should be given to the Director at this time to be placed in the lock box.

Pick up: When a child is picked up at the Center, please do the following:

- Greet the family by their names upon their arrival.
- If you are unsure of the identity of the person who has arrived to pick up the child(ren). Check with the Director or your team member for a message from the parent. Even with the parent's permission, if you have not met this person before, ask

for a photo identification and check it against the name provided by the parent. Only those individuals who are authorized in writing or by the telephone by the parent/guardian are permitted to take a child from the Center. This is further discussed below.

- Tell the family about something good that happened. Only discuss challenges if this has been discussed with your team members and Director and a decision has been made that the parents need to be informed. Have the discussion in private.
- Make sure the family has all papers, projects, notes, etc. that are intended to go home with the child.
- For families who receive Child Care Connections assistance, remind the parent to clock out properly.
- Wish them a good evening and say goodbye.

Irregular Attendance

For children attending part time or with irregular schedules parents must submit a weekly or monthly attendance calendar in advance.

Late Pick up Policy

Parents must ensure arrangements have been made for pick up of their child by the designated time on the registration form. The centre closes at 6:00 pm. The Director will take into consideration late pick up due to RARE and unusual circumstances i.e. car accident, excessive snowstorm, or car breakdown. However, a phone call is appreciated. High traffic volumes and accidents slowing down traffic are regular occurrences and will be considered late. **A late fee of \$1.00 for each minute past 6:00 pm will be charged.**

Parent Interaction

We believe that parents are the primary caregivers for their child and must be respected as such. It is important to build positive relationships with families, as this is the foundation for best outcomes for children. We respect families' child rearing practices and any diversity they bring to the Centre.

While general guidelines for interacting with parents (and other members of the general public) are in the preceding sections, this covers a few, more specific items.

- In general, talk to the parents whenever possible. We need to maintain open lines of communication with them at all times.
- Daily communication is required, as noted in the Drop Off and Pick Up procedures.
- Any relevant information acquired from parents must be documented in the staff communication books to be shared with team members. This information may later be used in program planning or in guiding children.
- Take opportunities to invite parents to provide input to the programming in your room.
- Take every opportunity to discuss with the parent(s) what positive things the child has done that day.
- If the parent has specific questions related to behaviours, please do not discuss this in front of other children and families. Ask a co-worker or Director to take your place while you conduct the discussion with the parent in the privacy of the office.

Open-Door Policy

- Zahra Daycare Ltd maintains an open-door policy and families are welcome to visit at any time.
- We encourage parental involvement, through volunteering and in classroom participation.
- We provide families with an opportunity to discuss their child/children's progress. (biannually)
- We shall support the diversity and uniqueness of our families through various celebrations & events.
- We encourage families to participate, make suggestions, provide input, and welcome any feedback.
- The centre shall ensure there is a consistent exchange of daily information through verbal and written communication, between the staff and families.

Inclusion and Diversity

At Zahra Daycare Ltd, cultural heritage is an integral part of programming. We ensure a variety of cultural and inclusive activities and materials are provided and available to children. We encourage all children and families to share their cultural traditions and celebrations. Staff members provide children with opportunities to celebrate individual differences and unique qualities. Zahra Daycare Ltd Centre will accept children of diversity depending on our ability to meet their needs and provide the type of environment they require.

Daily Routine

A routine that is consistent from day to day gives children a specific way to understand time. Once children have participated in the sequence of the daily routine a number of times, they will begin to feel more secure as they understand time as a predictable sequence of events without depending the adults to tell what happen next.

Children are provided with large blocks of time to play so they may develop play scenarios, get organized, and then execute their plan. Many valuable skills and much learning is gained as children make sense of their world through play. Daily routine includes active and quiet times, time with friends and time to play alone. Many opportunities are given for children to interact individually or as part of a group. Arts, music, science, language activities, dramatic and outdoor play ensue a well-balanced day that combines learning with fun. Outdoor play is a mandatory part of the daily program. Children require appropriate clothing, suited for the weather.

We encourage and welcome families to participate in our program. (Please see Parental Involvement)

Your Classroom

There are many components that go into making your classroom a safe and fun learning environment for the children at Zahra Daycare Ltd. You will be provided with a wide range of materials to help you maintain and develop appropriate program plans and curricula for the children in your classroom, along with other items containing important information about the children under your care

Curriculum

At Zahra Daycare Ltd, our curriculum promotes a child centred, learning through play program, using a variety of activities and techniques to reach particular goals.

Our developmentally appropriate curriculum provides for the whole child; it combines physical, emotional, social, and cognitive learning through an integrated approach. Each of these domains is interconnected and impacts the others.

Children learn by doing. Through active involvement with others and their environment, children attempt to make sense of the world around them. They learn by exploring their environment through hands-on experience. Teaching young children is a creative process. An early childhood curriculum provides the framework for what actually happens in a planned environment where children interact with materials, peers, and adults. The primary teaching goal is to help young children use the environment productively and see themselves as capable learners. They will acquire the skills and abilities needed for a lifetime of learning through carefully planned, developmentally appropriate activities implemented by the teachers. All teachers are to engage in play with children, supporting interests, provoking curiosity and extending play and learning.

When a learning environment meets the needs of individual children, they develop a sense of trust and belonging. They feel important and valued when others listen to them, seek out their ideas, and allow them to express themselves.

Children in our classrooms are encouraged to discover things on their own. They learn by exploring the actual objects we talk about. The teachers inspire the children by asking open- ended questions and finding new ways to teach new things within the subject area.

Program Planning

Program planning is based on children's interests and developmental needs. Through observations, engagement with children and discussions with parents, teachers will determine current interests in the room. This will be the topic of the program plan. There may be more than one interest in a room at any given time.

Program plans must be completed and posted every Monday morning. It is your responsibility to ensure the environment correlates with your program plan and your program plan is based on the children's interests. Children must be provided with a large variety of open-ended activities in all developmental domains prior to their arrival. Program plans must also include developmentally appropriate activities that promote literacy, math, social studies, science, etc.

Most experiences must be open-ended, especially for infants and toddlers and must include all developmental domains.

Outdoor Play

The children have daily opportunities for outdoor play in a safe, stimulating and developmentally appropriate environment usually at our playground

The play yard is meant to be an extension of our classroom. The items that are in the classroom are items that can be adapted for outside use. For instance: the easel. Typically, an easel is set up in the classroom, but outside it becomes different experience for the children. The same goes for the discovery table, dress up, dramatic play, blocks, science, etc. Outside we also play games and, best of all, we get to do lots of things that are unacceptable inside, like yelling and running.

We may also use the Henry Legay Park, or community walking trails. Staff carry an emergency backpack at all times when offsite. The Emergency Backpack contains; emergency phone numbers, children's emergency contact information, first aid kit, tissues, wipes and garbage bag. During the summer we also carry water, extra shirts, sunscreen, and bug spray. Children are to be appropriately dressed for the weather at all times.

Circle Time

Children are not to be forced to participate in circle time therefore, alternative activities must be available. Circle time is meant to be a fun and interactive time where children can experience large group activities. Where appropriate (older preschool and kindergarten), children learn about the days of the week, the months, the weather (and weather predictions), the alphabet, and counting. They also find out their jobs of the day.

Fieldtrip Policy

Throughout the year we do take the children off the premises as an enhancement to our program. Some of our programs will require the children to be transported by public and/or private transportation. Staff members enforce safety rules that comply with Transport Canada Guidelines. When a fieldtrip is planned, parents will be notified by newsletter, our website and in person. A written parental consent is required on the field trip form, which will also include the destination, mode of transportation, time of departure and arrival and supervision details. We require additional adults to accompany the group on many of our fieldtrips to ensure we meet or exceed the fieldtrip facilities minimum adult to child ratio. Parents are welcome to volunteer for any fieldtrips. Volunteers on fieldtrips are responsible for having fun and spending some fun quality time with their child. Volunteers are not allowed to be alone with any children other than their own and will be asked to stay with the group.

Before each fieldtrip the staff will prepare the children by explaining where they are going, what will happen, whom they will see and who they need to listen to. The staff will also review the safety rules with the children and parent volunteers prior to each fieldtrip.

Developmentally Appropriate Practices

Our teachers use developmentally appropriate practices to nurture the social, emotional, physical, creative and cognitive development of each child, always putting the needs of children first. The theories of early childhood education are used to implement the curriculum. Assessments are done to identify the strengths of each child as well as the needs of each child. These assessments help us to tailor the curriculum to the needs of each classroom.

Technology/Movie Viewing Policy

To enhance an activity or interest in a room, staff may wish to have the children watch a movie. With this in mind, the following guidelines must be adhered to.

1. Only movies rated "G" are to be viewed.
2. Movies must be screened by staff prior, to ensure they meet the developmental needs of the Children and are appropriate
3. Other supervised activities are to be made available for children who do not wish to watch the movie
4. Staff are to sit with the children while they are watching the movie, still being able to supervise any children who do not wish to watch the movie.
5. The title of the movie, length and rating are to be recorded on the program planning sheet.
6. The theme or content of the movie must be related to what is being discussed/planned in the room.
7. Movie viewing shall not exceed the following:
Toddler Room -1 hour a month broken down to 1/2 hour every other week
2/3 Room -1 hour a month broken down to 1/2 hour every other week
3/4 Room - 3 hours a month broken down to 1.5 hours every other week
4/5 Room - 3 hours a month broken down to 1.5 hours every other week

Computer Usage

To enhance a theme or to provide an additional activity in a room, staff may wish to have the children play an education computer game. With this in mind the following guidelines must be adhered to.

1. Only programs/games rated "G" or any age are to be used.
2. Any program/game must be screened by staff prior to it being used.
3. Any program/game with violence or inappropriate language is not to be used.
4. The program/game must be education in content.
5. Computer usage is limited to 15 minutes at any one time.

Age Appropriateness

Child development research indicates that there are universal, predictable sequences of growth and changes that occur in children during the first nine years of life. These predictable changes occur in all domains of development – physical, cognitive, emotional, social and intellectual.

Knowledge of the typical development of children within the age groups served by our programs provides the framework from which teachers prepare the learning environment and plan appropriate experiences.

Individual Appropriateness

Each child is a unique person with an individual pattern and timing of growth, as well as an individual personality, learning style, culture and family background. Both the curriculum and adults' interactions with children should be responsive to those individual differences. Learning in young children is the result of interaction between the child's thoughts and experiences with materials, ideas, and people.

Incidents and Accidents Reporting

In this section, "incident" means a serious illness of or injury to a child that occurs while the child is attending a program, and any other incident that occurs while a child is attending a program that may seriously affect the health or safety of the child.

Our program will maintain an onsite incident/accident reporting form to report any occurrence for any child. Descriptors on form will include name of child, date of birth, time at which incident/accident happened, what was the incident or accident, where it happened, how it happened, form of first aid applied if applicable, who administered first aid treatment, time parents were notified of incident or accidents.

Reporting staff will sign and date form, program director will read, sign and date form, and parent/guardian will read, sign and date form as well. Parents will receive immediate telephone call to inform them about any bodily harm or injury to their child before arrival.

Any serious incidents will be reported immediately using prescribed form to our licensing office or Regional Child and Family Services office.

Serious incidents include any of the following:

1. Emergency evacuation
2. Program closure due to an emergency
3. Intruder on the program premises
4. A child removed from the program by a person without parent/guardian consent
5. An injury requiring medical attention
6. A lost child or a child left on the premises after operating hours.

Biting Incident:

This particular kind of incident is documented separately for children 3 and under. All other ages should use the Behavioral Incident form instead. As with the previous form, the Biting Incident must be documented for both children, withholding the identifying information as noted above. If the bite draws blood, the Director needs to be notified immediately, regardless of the age of the children involved.

Child Discipline Policy

It is recognized that children are at different stages in their development of appropriate group behavioral skills. At our Daycare program, key rules are established to maintain harmony and safety for all of the children. Where appropriate, children are included in setting rules for their rooms. If consequences are imposed, they are logical consequences, making the whole incident a learning opportunity, rather than a punishment. Staff will follow through in a calm, reasonable, and consistent manner when a child behaves inappropriately

Methods that will be used when guiding and redirecting behavior:

- Caregivers will communicate to children using positive statements
- Caregivers will communicate with children by getting down to their eye level and talking to them in a calm quiet manner about what behavior is expected
- After the child is reminded of the appropriate behavior, he/she will be redirected through alternatives/ choices to another activity or area
- Staff will promote and encourage appropriate behavior through knowledgeable program planning, modeling desirable behaviors, and socially acceptable language
- The goal that we are striving for is for children to take responsibility for their own actions and behaviors
- Any person, while on child care premises, shall not engage in any of the following actions toward children
- Inflict corporal punishment in any manner upon a child's body
- Hit, spank, beat, shake, pinch, or any other measure that produces physical discomfort
- Cruel, harsh, unusual, humiliating, or frightening methods of discipline, including threatening the use of physical punishment
- Placement in a locked or dark room
- Public or private humiliation, yelling, or abusive or profane language
- Staff shall not associate disciplinary action or rewards with rest, food, or toileting
- Caregivers shall not use time out for any child
- Caregivers shall not use time out for any purpose

Staff are not to inflict or cause to be inflicted any form of physical punishment, verbal or physical degradation or emotional deprivation,

(b) deny or threaten to deny any basic necessity, or

(c) use or permit the use of any form of physical restraint, confinement or isolation (includes time out)

Child Guidance & Bullying

Through discipline we help children develop self-control. We want children to feel strong and self-confident and at the same time respect adults and other children. Children who like themselves and feel esteemed by others rarely act rebellious or sullen. Discipline refers to actions taken by adults to help children control their behavior. These actions include identifying what kinds of behavior are acceptable and helping the child to understand the possible consequences of unacceptable behavior. Giving a child the reason for why he is not allowed to touch or do something helps him in learning to manage his own behavior in the future. Adults help children to develop self-control by being consistent, predictable and by modeling desirable behavior.

The center has clear rules that will be followed consistently with each individual child. When making rules we refer to the following guidelines:

- We cannot let children hurt other children
- We cannot let children hurt themselves
- We cannot let children destroy equipment or property
- We cannot let the children bully others in any way

The rooms will be set up and the program planned appropriately in order to prevent undesirable behavior. The teachers recognize when children are becoming bored and frustrated and when they need to change activities. Our staff uses positive reinforcement to encourage the behaviors we want to see and to build self-esteem in the children. We will never use sarcasm, physical force, or embarrassment to discipline a child. Physical punishment of children, including hitting and spanking will not be allowed under any circumstance. Other discipline methods that are unacceptable include time outs, harsh or degrading measures that humiliate or undermine a child's self-respect, isolating a child, or withholding basic needs such as food, shelter, clothing, bedding or affection.

Guiding the Behavior for Infants and Toddlers

During the first years of life, bonding and trust are encouraged through the presence of a consistent and responsive caregiver. Security is strengthened in the infant when he knows that all of his needs will quickly be met. The teachers follow these guidelines to help prevent undesirable behavior:

1. Give infants attention on an individual basis throughout the day. Develop a relationship with each child as if he/she were the only child in the center.
2. Plan a room arrangement that minimizes traffic and allows for everything to be at the child's level. Make it simple.
3. Prepare and put out interesting activities in all centers
4. Establish a routine that alternates quiet activities and active activities.
5. Meet an infant's needs promptly so that he/she may develop a strong, happy, and trusting relationship.
6. Have a close relationship with the parents and solicit information about their children.
7. Play on the floor, close at all times to encourage and reinforce appropriate behaviors with words of praise and positive reinforcements.
8. Set clear limits and be consistent.
9. Always focus on what the child is to do rather than what he is not to do.
10. Redirect if a child needs help with his/her behavior.

Toddlers:

1. Developmentally, toddlers feel everything is about them. It is important to have multiples of the same toys to avoid ongoing conflicts.
2. Develop a relationship with each child as if he/she were the only child in the center.
3. Arrange the room with defined play spaces and minimal open areas
4. Provide an environment that fosters independence
5. Ensure routines are consistent.
6. Establish close relationships with parents and solicit information about their children.
7. Encourage behavior you want them to continue with words of praise and positive reinforcements.
8. Set clear limits and be consistent.
9. Focus on what the child is to do rather than what he is not to do.

10. Redirect the child to another activity to give him/her the opportunity to change his /her behavior
11. When solving conflicts, provide choices so they feel they have some control
12. Prepare and put out interesting activities in all centers in keeping with each particular child's current level of achievement, interest, ability and needs.
13. Provide sensory play

Guiding the Behavior of Three, Four and Five Year Olds

- Develop a relationship with each child as if he/she were the only child in the center.
- Plan a room arrangement that minimizes traffic and discourages the children from running.
- Prepare and put out interesting activities in all centers in keeping with each particular child's current level of achievement, interest, ability and needs.
- Establish a routine that alternates quiet activities with active activities.
- Establish close relationships with parents and solicit information about their children.
- Take time to teach children to use the materials properly and be consistent in reminding them.
- Encourage behavior you want them to continue with words of praise and positive reinforcements.
- Set clear limits and be consistent.
- Focus on what the child is to do rather than what he is not to do.
- Redirect the child to another activity to give him/her the opportunity to change his /her behavior.
- If s child continues the unacceptable behavior, he/she will be given the logical consequence of his/her actions.
- When children are fighting teachers will intervene immediately and stop the children from hitting each other. Teachers will teach them to solve the problem without hitting.
- If the child loses control of his emotions and is crying uncontrollably, shouting, or having a temper tantrum we will ensure they are safe and deal with the situation once they have released the negative behavior.

Guiding the Behavior of 6-12 year olds

- Develop a relationship with each child as if he/she were the only child in the center.
- These one on one interactions will help staff recognize the strengths and weaknesses of each child.
- Prepare a learning environment that minimizes traffic, promotes consistent routines and states well- defined expectations.
- Prepare and put out interesting activities in all centers in keeping with each particular child's current level of achievement, interest, ability and needs.
- Establish a routine that alternates quiet activities with active activities.
- Establish close relationships with the parents and solicit information from them about their children.
- Take time to teach the children to use the materials properly and be consistent in reminding them.
- Always encourage behavior you want to continue with words of praise and positive reinforcements.
- Set clear limits and be consistent.
- Always focus on what the child is to do rather than what he is not to do.
- Use problem solving where appropriate. Teachers and children will talk through the situation while staff asks supporting questions to enable the children to come up with another alternative or solution to their problem.
- If the child continues the unacceptable behavior we will give him/her the logical consequence of his/her actions.
- When a child causes physical or emotional harm to him/herself or other, the child will be asked to remove themselves from the situation in order to allow the child to calm down. They may choose another area to play in. Staff will talk with the children involved about alternate and appropriate behaviors. Children will then learn how to solve the problem without harming themselves or others.
- If the child loses control of his emotions and is crying uncontrollably, shouting, or having a temper tantrum, he/she will be will be comforted and given the space to calm down. Once he/she has released his/her negative behavior the staff will then help the child to express him/herself in a safe appropriate way.
 1. Implement an interest based, child directed, open-ended program with activities that are developmentally appropriate and challenging.
 2. Involve children in setting rules and consequences for their room.
 3. Explain reasons for the rules
 4. Set clear expectations.
 5. Be consistent with routines/schedules and follow through on rules and logical consequences.
 6. Provide sincere positive reinforcement, naming the act or behaviour.

7. Use positive language, telling children what to do instead of what not to do.

When children display negative behaviour, staff remind them why their behaviour is inappropriate. If they continue, they will give them a warning of consequences. If they still continue, a logical consequences will be imposed.

Supervision Policy

To ensure that staffs are aware that every child in attendance at Zahra Daycare Ltd & OSC Centre must be supervised by a staff at all times.

PROCEDURES FOR CHILD SUPERVISION

All children upon arrival or departure must be marked in or out on the daily attendance sheet, indicating the time of arrival or departure. This must be done at the time when the child is released from the parent/guardian to the receiving staff upon arrival or from the supervising staff to the parent/guardian upon departure. All children who attend school, upon arrival or departure to school, must be marked in or out on the daily attendance, in addition to the recording of daily arrival and departure at the centre. Daily attendance sheets must also record all children that are absent, on vacation, or absent due to illness. When beginning a shift staff must confirm verbally with the supervising staff on duty, the number of children in attendance and check this against the attendance sheet. This same procedure must be completed when leaving or returning from breaks, lunches, etc. Head counts of children are to be completed on a frequent basis throughout the day, minimally 2 to 3 times per hour. Head counts are to be checked against the attendance board. Head counts must be completed before and after a transition with a group of children from one activity area to another (e.g. Playroom to Playground). In addition to headcount, when a group of children are in transition from one activity area to another, staff must retain close visual supervision of the children at all times during the transition (e.g. Children should not run ahead of the group). All completed attendance sheets must be kept on file. In some cases, special considerations/procedures are put in place to ensure supervision of specific children. The Centre Supervisor/Designate will outline any special considerations/procedures currently in place at the location. Maintaining attendance records, in conjunction with constant supervision skills, is critical in ensuring the safety and well being of the children in our care.

SUPERVISION POLICY AND PRACTICES CAREGIVERS WILL ALWAYS:

Position them so as to ensure clear sight lines throughout the entire play space. Exceptions to the policy may include occasions where caregivers may be required to assist a child with toileting and diapering routines or in assisting a child in need of quiet or one on one care. In these instances, caregivers need to ensure communication of their absence to remaining caregivers so as to support increased momentary supervision challenges.

Will inform their coworkers whenever they are leaving the room or playground. Situate themselves equally around the play space either indoors or outside-carefully avoiding congregating or grouping together due to increased supervision needs during active play. Caregivers should wherever possible be actively engaged with children and facilitate interactions at the child's level as appropriate. Will strive to continually scan the playroom and/or playground, being alert to any potential issues that may increase risk of effective supervision or safety of children, Staff in our program will be made aware of the above guidelines and required to acknowledge content by signing. To ensure that staff effectively observes children's play and behaviors both indoors and outdoors, reminders about appropriate staff supervision of children during play both indoors and outdoors will be done during staff meetings and as needed throughout the day. Staff will also have opportunities to attend professional development training on varied topics such as programming, child guidance, and effective supervision of children plays both indoors and outdoors throughout the year. Staff in our program will receive periodic evaluations and a face to face feedback about work performances and expectations to ensure understanding about child supervision. Updates shared by childcare licensing regulations about child supervision will be passed on to all staff to support their work. All staff in our program will be made aware of the importance of staff child ratio to ensure adequate supervision during play indoors and outdoors.

To ensure that staff effectively observes children's play and behaviors both indoors and outdoors, reminders about appropriate staff supervision of children during play both indoors and outdoors will be done during staff meetings and as needed throughout the day.

Staff will also have opportunities to attend professional development training on varied topics such as programming, child guidance, and effective supervision of children plays both indoors and outdoors throughout the year.

Staff in our program will receive periodic evaluations and a face to face feedback about work performances and expectations to ensure understanding about child supervision. Updates shared by childcare licensing regulations about child supervision will be passed on to all staff to support their work. All staff in our program will hold a minimum

childcare certification of Level 1. Staff without childcare certification will not be left alone to supervise children. All staff will maintain required staff- child ratios Program staff is required to guide and model to children on how to safely interact with both indoors and outdoors toys to prevent hurting self or other children. Program administrator will ensure that all staff actively engages in developmental and age appropriate program planning in their classrooms. Staff is expected to have program planning posted to demonstrate that activities are planned for children to engage in interested play activities to minimize unwanted behaviors indoors and outdoors.

Outdoor program planning is also required to provide varied developmentally appropriate outdoor gross motor play opportunities for the children. All staff will be given the responsibility to daily check for and remove damaged toys within their rooms. Staff is to daily observe all room furniture and fixtures within room for damaged or repair needs and alert program administrator immediately.

Outdoor play equipment are also checked daily by staff for damages or need for repairs. Damaged outdoor play structure will be removed and items needing repairs will also be removed until properly fixed. Program staffs are given a walkthrough of the entire indoor and outdoor program facility during orientation to make sure all staff are aware of our indoor and outdoor physical environment layout.

Individual classroom maintains a classroom attendance sheet to account for the number of children in attendance daily. Staff are required to do a head count before, during and at the end of any outdoor activity to ensure that all children are accounted for both on and off program premises. The same practice is observed when children are entering or leaving program premises and especially during field trips requiring bus rides, staff is required to carry out a head count before entering and after leaving vehicle or bus. Staff responsible for transporting children from our program to other programs, are required to observe the same safety caution with the children. Our program supervision policy meets children developmental needs by maintaining required staff-child ratios at all times, observing and ensuring that all toys are developmentally and age appropriate for the children, damaged toys are completely removed from our premises and toys needing repairs are removed until repaired.

Staff in children supervision are all certified in early childhood certification levels, have a valid first aid/CPR/AED training, and all must have a clear criminal record check, staff are also well informed about our program's policies and procedures and know whom to communicate any questions they have for clarity. Program staff who do not hold any childhood certification level are not allowed to supervise children alone, and do not count in staff-child ratios.

SAFETY PROCEDURES FOR LEAVING THE ROOM WITH CHILDREN:

To ensure the safety and appropriate supervision of the children, the following procedures are to be utilized anytime children are leaving a room.

COUNTING THE CHILDREN PROCEDURE:

The children should be counted, during the following times when leaving the room without Exception:

- Role call and count before leaving the room.
- Role call and count on their way to a new area.
- Role call and count when they arrive at a new area.
- Role call and count periodically, while at the new area.
- Role call and count when leaving the area.
- Role call and count when you arrived back to your room & before entering the room.

WITHIN THE CENTRE:

- If you are dividing your children into two groups and one group is leaving the room, create a list and take it with you, make sure this information is written on your white board in the room. Write beside the children's names where they are. e.g. park, walk, playground
- If you are leaving the room with a group of children you need to write a list of the children you have and take it with you as well as their emergency cards. (For both partial and entire group)
- If you are taking a group of children by yourself, please have the children walked in front of you or you walk backwards so you can see all the children all the time.
- Ensure the role calling and counting children procedure above is also followed.

GOING FOR WALKS

- Count the children to ensure how many you have in total;
- Write on your white board where you have gone and when you will be back;
- Take a written list of what children you have and their emergency cards;
- Let the program supervisor know where you are going, how many children and the number of staff;
- Staff should be placed one at the front of the line, one at the back and any extra staff in the middle;
- Regularly count the children to ensure you are aware of where they all are;
- Upon returning to the center let the program supervisor know that you are back;
- Count the children -before re-entering the building;
- Ensure the counting children procedure above is also followed.

PRIOR TO GOING OUTSIDE

- Staffs are to ensure the outdoor environment is safe and complete the safety checklist.
- Ensure play equipment and structures comply with CSA Standards, remove any broken items.
- Ensure pools are drained when not in use and put aside. (upright)
- Ensure yard is free of toxic plants, e.g., thistles, nettle
- Check fence gates are latched and out of children's reach (Reg.19 2b)

RETURNING FROM OUTSIDE

- Line the children up against the wall and count to ensure all children are there.
- Staff, to position themselves one at the front and one at the back of the line
- Staff member at the front, will open door and stand in doorway, counting children as they enter.
- Second staff to do visual scans of yard to ensure no children are in yard, and then enter once all the children are inside.
- Assemble the children on the mat and count again to ensure all children are present before proceeding to room.
- Have children remove outside footwear.
- Second staff does visual scan to ensure no children are left behind before entering the room and closing the door.
- Adhering to the counting children procedure ensures safety for children and meets the guidelines of adequate supervision.

Physical Environment Policy

The centre shall provide an environment which will have a safety check conducted by staff daily prior to commencement of use. Any hazards will be fixed, removed or reported prior to children accessing the area to ensure safety of children and the risk is minimized.

Children's Health

Zahra Daycare Ltd takes the health of the children in our care very seriously. The policies below are our general expectations and procedures for various situations within your classroom and outside of it.

Food and Meals

Meals are an important time for the children. It is a social time as well as a time for nutrition. As you will be eating the same meals with the children, your attitude about food and meals will be reflected in the children. Your manners and etiquette are important. You teach by example. If you say that a food is disgusting, the children will believe you and imitate your feelings, not their own. Our menus are created to meet state nutrition guidelines and to provide healthy choices for the children.

Food Handling policy:

Zahra Daycare Ltd follows Canadian Food Guidelines for food handling, as required by law. You will be expected to set up and serve the snacks and meals to your classroom. Before handling any food, you should wash your hands with soap and water. Each utensil can only be used for one food. If the same type of utensil is needed for a second food, a new utensil must be used (the same utensil cannot be shared between the two dishes). The entire meal must be placed on the table prior to a child sitting in front of his/her plate. *Loss of meal and/or snack privileges may NOT be used as part of any disciplinary process.*

Meal Patterns:

Each age group has different serving size requirements, as noted on the menu. These serving sizes are determined by guidelines. Encourage children to serve themselves a full serving. If a child insists on not eating a specific food, ask them to just have a taste.

Infant and toddler meal procedures:

Infants who are bottle fed must be held for feeding. Infants who can eat solids can be encouraged to feed themselves with their hands. Staff may also feed with a spoon. Toddlers who can eat on their own should be encouraged to do so. Make sure a bib or extra t-shirt is put on the child prior to the meal, as this can be messy.

Food for the toddlers should be cut in pieces no larger than one inch in size.

Children are always to be seated while eating or drinking.

Infants may not have a bottle while sleeping

Health care

Zahra Daycare may provide or allow for the provision of health care to a child only if

- the written consent of the child's parent has been obtained, or
- the health care provided is in the nature of first aid.

Illness

Illnesses don't just affect the child who is ill; anyone who comes into contact with the child may also contract the illness. As such, employees must be aware of how to recognize the signs and symptoms of possible illness, and how to address those situations when they occur.

Illness and Medical Procedures

Upon enrollment at the centre, we require the medical status of the child, up to date immunization records and any known allergies or medical conditions. If a child becomes ill while attending the centre we will contact you promptly so that you may take your child home or to the doctor. An emergency contact including phone numbers and an address is necessary in the event that you cannot be reached. In an emergency the Director will take whatever immediate steps necessary to get medical help. You will be responsible for all costs associated for treatment and care. Parents are required to keep their child home if they display any of the following symptoms: fever, diarrhea, vomiting, undiagnosed rash/skin condition, obviously infected discharge, lethargy and irritability, persistent pain, cough, and communicable diseases as listed in Schedule 1 to the Communicable Disease Regulation (AR 238/85). A staff member who notices any of these symptoms when your child arrives

will ask that your child be taken home or to a doctor for a note confirming that your child is healthy and not infectious. If your child has had a fever, diarrhea or vomiting we ask that your child is kept at home for 24 hours after all symptoms are gone without the aid of Advil, Tylenol or other fever reducing medication.

Potential health risk

Where a staff member knows or has reason to believe that a child is exhibiting signs or symptoms of illness as set out in this subsection, (ZDL) must ensure that the child's parent arranges for the immediate removal of the child from the program premises, and that the child does not return to the program premises until our Centre (ZDL) is satisfied that the child no longer poses a health risk to persons on the program premises.

Signs or symptoms of illness exhibited by a child include the:

- child vomiting, having a fever, diarrhea or a new or unexplained rash or cough,
- requiring greater care and attention than can be provided without compromising the care of the other children in the program, or
- having or displaying any other illness or symptom the staff member knows or believes may indicate that the child poses a health risk to persons on the program premises.

To assess if a child is ill within our program, a Program staff will take child's body temperature using a thermometer to assess for fever, observe child's general temperament and play pattern, observe child's bowel movement type and frequency, and vomiting if any and observe child's eating during meal times.

Our program will record and document on file children who are removed because of an illness. Form will provide information about name of child, date the child was observed to be ill, name of staff member who identified the child was ill, time the parent was initially contacted, name of staff person who contacted the parent, time the child was removed from the program, and the date the child returned to the program and evidence provided to warrant return to the program. Document will also include where symptoms/traits have changed if applicable, including where parents are not called to pick up child.

This subsection does not apply if the child's parent provides written notice from a physician indicating the child does not pose a health risk to persons on the program premises.

Supervised care for sick children

(ZDL) must ensure that a sick child is kept as far away as is practicable from the other children, and directly supervised by a primary staff member.

Medication Policy

(ZDL) may administer or allow the administration of medication to a child only where:

- the written consent of the child's parent has been obtained,
- the medication is in the original labeled container, and
- the medication is administered according to the labeled directions.

Where medication is administered to a child, (ZDL) must ensure that the following information is recorded:

- the name of the medication;
- the time of administration;
- the amount administered;
- the initials of the person who administered the medication.

(ZDL) must ensure that

- all medication is stored in a locked container that is inaccessible to children,
- Medication that may be needed in an emergency is stored in a place that is inaccessible to children

Parent/guardian(s) must complete a form and send all medications for their child in the original container, clearly labeled with the physician's name, child's name, and date of issue, and instructions for administration. The Executive Director or Room Supervisor will only administer oral medications prescribed by a doctor. Non-prescribed medications will not be administered at the centre. Medications are kept in a locked cabinet (or locked container in fridge if appropriate). Once medicine has been given, the staff will watch for any reactions that could occur from the medication taken. Parent/Guardian will provide on medical form when medicine was last administered at home. All medication when finished will be given back to the parent for proper disposal.

Children with Allergies

Our Daycare staff will to the best of their abilities, create an environment that minimizes the risk of exposure to allergies. This policy recognizes that the risk of accidental exposure can be reduced but not eliminated.

Each child's needs will be assessed individually to determine if the centre can manage the allergy safely. The centre reserves the right to refuse registration if it is determined by the program director that the allergy is not safely manageable. Parents wishing to enroll their child(ren) in our program must discuss the child's allergies with the program director in advance of registration to determine if the centre can manage the child's allergies

To determine manageability we look at the following factors: a) type of allergy, b) number of allergies, c) level of severity, d) can exposure to allergen be managed safely and reasonably?, e) are staff and parents comfortable with level of risk that is inherent

Once it is determined that the allergy is manageable, then the following procedures must be followed before the child can be admitted into the program

The parent will provide an Allergy Information sheet that is signed by the child's physician:

- The parent will complete the allergy form that has been prepared by the centre. The parent will be able to meet and discuss this information with the centre's staff
- The parent will give written consent to advise other parents in the centre about their child's allergies and to allow us to post the child's Allergy Alert form in the center
- The parent will provide all necessary medications
- The parent will demonstrate the administration of the medication/ treatment to the program staff
- The program director and the parent will prepare a plan that outlines who will provide the food for the child (the centre or the parent or a combination of the two)
- The parent and program director will review the plan and the child's needs on a regular basis
- It is the parent's responsibility to notify the program coordinator, staff and cook of any changes to the child's allergy
- Any changes to the child's allergies must be noted and signed by the child's physician

Diapering

Diaper changing procedures are posted at each diaper-changing area.

- Place diaper-changing paper on diaper-changing table
- Change the child's diaper (use gloves if necessary - if there is blood or the child has had a bowel movement)
- Never walk away from the table while a child is on the changing table
- Let the child wash his or her hands, unless the child needs you to assist in washing
- Throw away the used diaper and other diaper-changing materials in the container designated for this kind of disposal
- Spray the table with sanitizer and wipe it off
- Wash your hands

Handwashing

Proper hand washing helps curb the spread of disease and promotes general hygiene. By modeling these behaviors for the children under your care, and insisting that they follow the same process, you help to ensure the health of everyone you encounter.

- Turn water on and wait for water to be warm
- Lather soap on your hands
- Rinse and scrub hands for 30 seconds
- Towel dry hands
- Use a disposable towel if you are using the toilet or assisting a child with toileting

Disinfecting

Staff members are responsible for cleaning each room daily and must initial the cleaning checklist once their duty has been completed. We occasionally have cleaners come on other days or for specific duties. Washrooms, toys, games, furniture, and play surfaces collect germs on a daily basis and therefore must be cleaned with the appropriate cleaners in order to prevent the spread of germs and infections.

Diapering surfaces and potty chairs are sanitized after each use using a bleach and water solution. Soiled diapers and garbage in the bathrooms are stored in closed containers. We use disposable paper towel that are discarded after each use. Any personal grooming items are labeled with the child's name. Each child uses his or her own personal bed linens that are washed each week.

Emergency Situations

Parents are immediately notified in the case of a medical emergency. Examples of medical emergencies include any suspected head related injuries or broken bones. Parents will be notified immediately. A child sustaining serious injuries will be taken via ambulance to a hospital, at the expense of the parents. A staff member will escort the child and stay with them until a parent arrives.

Fire Drills and Evacuations

Emergency procedures are posted at all emergency exits and fire drills are practiced with the children each month.

1. If a staff discovers fire, smells smoke or gas he/she will operate the fire alarm and warn other staff members and visitors at once. Staff will then start the evacuation procedure immediately. The Director or acting Director will take the emergency contact binder, the attendance book and phone 911.
2. Staff will remain calm and encourage children to stay calm and not run.
3. Staff will gather emergency back pack and attendance
4. All children and staff will exit out the nearest door and proceed to the meeting point (Muster Point) west of building at the NW corner of Parking lot.
5. The Director or alternate Director will check all the rooms and bathrooms and proceed to the meeting point. Staffs members will take a head count and roll call and ensure all children are accounted for
6. If anyone is missing, the Director will be sent to locate the missing child.
7. Staff and children will remain at the Muster Point until otherwise notified by the Fire Chief or other person in charge.
8. If re-entry into the building is denied, Staff and children will proceed to the McDonald Building. Once settled, parents will be contacted and asked to make arrangements for immediate pick up of their child(ren).

Emergency and safety contacts and procedures

(ZDL) must ensure that the following telephone numbers are posted on the program premises and are readily accessible:

- Emergency medical service;
- Ambulance service;
- Fire department;
- Police service;
- Poison control centre;
- Nearest hospital or emergency medical facility;
- Child abuse hotline.

(ZDL) must ensure that the telephone number for an after-hours emergency program contact is posted in a place that is visible from the outside of the program premises.

(ZDL) must ensure that emergency evacuation procedures are made known to all staff and to children where developmentally appropriate.

Off-site activity and emergency evacuation

(ZDL) must ensure that in the case of an activity off the program premises or an emergency evacuation a staff member takes the portable record referred to in section in respect of each child to be taken off the program premises.

Smoking

In accordance with the Child Care regulation, our staff will ensure that no person smokes on the program premises. Also no staff member shall smoke at any time or place where child care is being provided

As children are not always able to move away from a smoker as adults are able to, we will strictly adhere to the smoke free environment policy. The objective of this policy is to protect all persons from the effects of environmental tobacco smoke, including passive smoking

Parents, family members or relatives of children enrolled at the service will not be permitted to smoke on the premises and will adhere to our Smoke Free Environment Policy

As Per Child Care Licensing Regulations:

Children's Record

(ZDL) must, in respect of each child, maintain on the program premises an up-to-date record containing the following information:

- the child's name, date of birth and home address;
- a completed enrolment form;
- the parent's name, home address and telephone number;
- the name, address and telephone number of a person who can be contacted in case of an emergency;
- if medication is administered,

The written consent of the parent required under this section the particulars of any health care provided to the child, including the written consent of the child's parent required under section any other relevant health information about the child provided by the child's parent, including the child's immunizations and allergies, if any.

Our Centre (ZDL) must ensure that a record referred to in subsection is available for inspection by the director at all times, and by the child's parent at reasonable times.

Portable Record

(ZDL) must maintain a portable record of emergency information, including the following:

- (a) the child's name, date of birth and home address
- (b) the parent's name, home address and telephone number
- (c) the name, address and telephone number of a person who can be contacted in case of an emergency
- (d) any other relevant health information about the child provided by the child's parent, including the child's immunizations and allergies, if any
- (e) The telephone numbers of the local emergency response service and poison control centre.

Administrative Records

(ZDL) must maintain on the program premises up-to-date administrative records containing the following information:

- particulars of the daily attendance of each child, including arrival and departure times;
- particulars of the daily attendance of each primary staff member, including
- arrival and departure times, and
- hours spent providing child care;
- with respect to the program supervisor and each primary staff member,
- evidence of the supervisor's or member's child care
- certification, and
- a current first aid certificate, where applicable;
- with respect to each staff member and each volunteer referred to in section of this Schedule, verification that a current criminal record check required under that section has been provided to the licence holder.

(ZDL) must ensure that the records referred to in this subsection are available for inspection by the director at all times, the information referred to in subsection is available for inspection by the child's parent at reasonable times, and the information referred to in subsection is retained for a minimum period of 2 years.

Staff

All staff members and volunteers are required to hand in a recent Criminal Record Check including a vulnerable sector search upon starting or within 8 weeks of starting their position. This is in the staff Handbook. The Criminal Record Check including a vulnerable sector search will be submitted and dated not earlier than 6 months prior to the date of commencement with our program and then resubmitted every 3 years after that date.

Staffing Plan

With 09 classrooms, we will operate our program with 17 full time primary Staff excluding program director in the following Certification Levels:

3 Early Childhood Development Supervisors 6 Early Childhood Development Assistants 8 Early childhood

Staff-Child Supervision Ratios by Rooms

0-12 months old: 1 to 3 children
13-18 months old: 1 to 4 children
19-35 months old: 1 to 6 children
36 months to 4.5 Years: 1 to 8 children
4.5 Years and up: 1 to 10 children

We will always have a program supervisor on program premises at all times between 8:30 AM and 4:30 PM daily. Our program will have onsite relief staff to assist with lunch breaks, nap time routines, and other duties to support smooth operation of our program routine. We will always meet the minimum staffing standards set out by the Licensing Regulations. During nap times, our ratio doubles. However, our program will strive to have 2 staff member supervision during nap times whenever possible or needed especially in cases where we have children who do not nap for very long or children who do not nap at all. Staff members take their lunch breaks during nap time.

Minimum staffing and general supervision

ZDL must ensure that where 7 or more children are present at a program, whether on or off the program premises, a minimum of 2 adult staff members, one of whom is a primary staff member, are on duty, and children are, at all times, under supervision that is adequate to ensure their safety, well-being and development.

Our program supports families who need assistance to transport children enrolled into other local neighboring programs. Please check with us for schools we transport to and for spots availability. We also request parents' sign our transportation contract and inform us of any changes to their pick-up or drop off schedule.

Transportation contract form will include name of child (ren), school year, and specific school name, drop off and pick up time. Our program will inform parents about type of transportation provided, all stops within the transportation routine if applicable, and staff-child supervision arrangements. Transporting staff will not have more than 5 children to transport at the same time. Relevant portable records will always accompany the transporting staff in respect of each child to be taken off our program premises.

Our program maintains onsite a list of all children to be transported, name and telephone numbers of local schools attending, days attending, drop-off and pick up time. Staff responsible for transport must have a driving record abstract on file, and emergency contact cards of each child to be transported on self at all times during this transition.

Our program requires transport staff walk down with children to the schools and into transporting vehicle during drop off and pick-up. No child will be left in transporting vehicle during transporting routine stops. This practice is to ensure that all children are accounted for. Unless, advised by parent/guardian, transport staff is always aware of the number of children to expect to pick-up or drop-off each school day. Parents are encouraged to call in to inform our program of any changes.

Staff will introduce self to attending schools and personally meet and get familiar with children's specific classroom teachers. In the event that a child fails to show up at the centre on a regular school day for drop-off, transport staff is required to call parent to confirm child's attendance. If a child fails to show up at the arranged pick-up time or location, an inquiry is made with the attending school to confirm child's attendance. A parent may be called to clear any miscommunication or informed about a potential risk of child's disappearance. Appropriate authorities will also be immediately contacted to alert of a removal of child without parental consent.

Staff will always position themselves so as to ensure clear sight lines throughout the entire play space. Exceptions to the policy may include occasions where Staff may be required to assist a child with toileting and diapering routines or in assisting a child in need of quiet or one on one care. In these instances, Staff needs to ensure communication of their absence to remaining Staff so as to support increased momentary supervision challenges. Will inform their coworkers whenever they are leaving the room or playground. Situate them equally around the play space either indoors or outside-carefully avoiding congregating or grouping together due to increased supervision needs during active play. Staff should

wherever possible be actively engaged with children and facilitate interactions at the child's level as appropriate. ZDL will strive to continually scan the playroom and/or playground, being alert to any potential issues that may increase risk of effective supervision or safety of children. All staff in our program will be made aware of the above guidelines and required to acknowledge content by signing.

To ensure that staff effectively observes children's play and behaviors both indoors and outdoors, reminders about appropriate staff supervision of children during play both indoors and outdoors will be done during staff meetings and as needed throughout the day. Staff will also have opportunities to attend professional development training on varied topics such as programming, child guidance, and effective supervision of children plays both indoors and outdoors throughout the year. Staff in our program will receive periodic evaluations and a face to face feedback about work performances and expectations to ensure understanding about child supervision. Updates shared by childcare licensing regulations about child supervision will be passed on to all staff to support their work.

All staff in our program will be made aware of the importance of staff child ratio to ensure adequate supervision during play indoors and outdoors. To ensure that staff effectively observes children's play and behaviors both indoors and outdoors, reminders about appropriate staff supervision of children during play both indoors and outdoors will be done during staff meetings and as needed throughout the day.

ZDL will ensure that all staff actively engages in developmental and age appropriate program planning in their classrooms. Staff is expected to have program planning posted to demonstrate that activities are planned for children to engage in interested play activities to minimize unwanted behaviors indoors and outdoors. Outdoor program planning is also required to provide varied developmentally appropriate outdoor gross motor play opportunities for the children.

All staff will be given the responsibility to daily check for and remove damaged toys within their rooms. Staff is to daily observe all room furniture and fixtures within room for damaged or repair needs and alert program administrator immediately. Outdoor play equipments are also checked daily by staff for damages or need for repairs. Damaged outdoor play structure will be removed and items needing repairs will also be removed until properly fixed. Program staffs are given a walkthrough of the entire indoor and outdoor program facility during orientation to make sure all staffs are aware of our indoor and outdoor physical environment layout. Each classroom will have an outdoor floor map identifying different outdoor play structures, locations and exits to support outdoor program planning.

Individual classroom maintains a classroom attendance sheet to account for the number of children in attendance daily. Staff are required to do a head count before, during and at the end of any outdoor activity to ensure that all children are accounted for both on and off program premises. The same practice is observed when children are entering or leaving program premises and especially during field trips requiring bus rides, staff is required to carry out a head count before entering and after leaving vehicle or bus. Staff responsible for transporting children from our program to other programs, are required to observe the same safety caution with the children.

PERSONNEL POLICIES

Zahra Daycare Ltd strives to employ people who are the best qualified to meet the needs of the Center and the children under our care. Employment shall be on the basis of proven competence or potential ability as indicated by academic achievements, personal attitude, and prior work experience in accordance with the necessary qualifications and essential duties listed on the job description.

The employment of all persons shall be contingent upon the approval of the Director.

EQUAL OPPORTUNITY EMPLOYER/NON-DISCRIMINATION POLICY

Zahra Daycare Ltd is an Equal Opportunity Employer. All employment activities will be conducted in a manner to assure equal opportunity for all and will be based solely on the individual merit and fitness of applicants, candidates, and/or employees without regard to race, color, religion, creed, sex, gender, age, national origin, sexual orientation, pregnancy, or disability.

Employees hired for positions where the primary responsibility is direct child care must be eighteen (18) years of age. Employees who are in the Continuity of Care room must be twenty-one (21) years of age, and must be able to lift up to

25 pounds.

EMPLOYMENT AT THE CENTER

Once an applicant has been offered a position at Zahra Daycare Ltd, there are a number of additional criteria which must be met by the applicant within a prescribed time period in order to be employed at the Center. These include health and safety screening of the applicant, along with other required documentation which must be submitted and completed during the application process or within a pre-determined span of time upon being hired.

STAFF ORIENTATION PROCESS

Potential staff members are given a tour of the centre, introduced to other staff members and the program's philosophy, values and goals are discussed. The program director will review the staff handbook, including schedules and vacations with the applicant and answer and questions they may have. They are asked to come and spend some time in the room they may be working in. This allows us to observe their skill with the children and interaction with other staff members, and it allows the applicant to see if they feel comfortable in the environment. They are then paired with a seasoned staff for mentoring and coaching. It is made very clear that either the director or designate is always available to answer any questions regarding schedules, policies, etc. The entire orientation includes: Employ information, administrative policies, administrative procedures, introductions and tour and position information

CONDUCT AND ETHICS

The reputation of Zahra Daycare Ltd is built upon the ethical conduct of our employees, and the overall success of the business is tied to this as well. Our reputation for integrity and excellence requires careful observance of the spirit and letter of applicable laws and regulations, as well as a scrupulous regard for the highest professional standards of conduct and personal integrity.

Zahra Daycare Ltd is dependent upon our families' trust and we are dedicated to preserving that trust. Employees have a duty to Zahra Daycare Ltd and its families to act in a way that will merit the continued trust and confidence of the public.

Zahra Daycare Ltd will comply with all applicable laws and regulations and expects its directors and employees to conduct business in accordance with the letter, spirit, and intent of all relevant laws, statutes, ordinances, and regulations and to refrain from any illegal, dishonest, or unethical conduct.

In general, the use of good judgment, based on high ethical principles, will guide employees with respect to acceptable conduct. When a situation arises where it is difficult to determine the proper course of action, the employee should discuss the matter with the Director/Assistant Director.

Staff members shall always model appropriate behavior with other adults and take opportunities to model proper manners and respect for the children.

Compliance with these principles of conduct and ethics is the responsibility of every Zahra Daycare Ltd employee. Disregarding or failing to meet any of the following standards may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination.

CONFIDENTIALITY

This Confidentiality Policy has been adopted to insure the confidentiality and protection of individual rights of privacy for children, families, and employees of Zahra Daycare Ltd. The individual dignity of children, families, and employees shall be respected and protected at all times in accordance with all applicable laws.

Information about children, families, or employees will not be divulged to anyone other than persons who are authorized to receive such information. This policy extends to both internal and external disclosure of information.

An employee's responsibility to maintain confidentiality regarding information learned about children, their parents/guardians, families, and other employees applies 24 hours per day, 7 days per week regardless of how or where the information was obtained. Employees must be

diligent in their efforts to maintain confidentiality, and should be aware that there are job- related consequences for violations of confidentiality and rights of privacy, and that there is the potential for civil liability against the individual employee and the Center.

Confidentiality of Children's and Families' Information

- All children's private records (home address, medical file, etc.) must be locked in a secure file.
- Classroom binders are not considered private records, but will only contain information specific and necessary to the care of each individual child. Access to classroom binders is restricted to staff members who work in that specific classroom or the Director.
- Access to children's records is limited to employees with a "need to know."
- Children's records must not be removed from the Center.
- Children's records must never be left out on desks, tables, etc. where others may have access to them.
- Children's or families' private information must never be discussed among employees except on a "need to know" basis. Employees must be particularly aware of their surroundings when discussing this information. Special caution must be taken to ensure other children, families, or employees do not overhear information that is confidential.
- Discussion of children's or families' information with volunteers, other families, friends, or community members is prohibited.
- Information and documents which are considered to be confidential include, but are not limited to, medical records, educational records, special needs records, family records, financial records, and any other private information about the children or their families.
- All requests for release of information shall be made to the Director.
- Information will only be released to persons outside of MCCC with the express written consent of the child's parent or legal guardian.

Confidentiality of Employee's Information

- All employee records must be locked in a secure file.
- General access to an employee's records is limited to the Director and Assistant Director.
- An employee's records must not be removed from the Center.
- An employee's records must never be left out on desks, tables, etc. where other people may have access to them.
- An employee's private information will never be discussed among employees except on a "need to know" basis. Employees must be particularly aware of their surroundings when discussing this information. Special caution must be taken to ensure children, families, or employees do not overhear information that is confidential.
- Discussion of an employee's information with volunteers, families, friends, or community members is prohibited.
- Information and documents which are considered to be confidential include, but are not limited to, medical records, educational records, employment records, financial or pay records, and any other private information about the employee.
- All requests for release of information to persons outside of TBCC shall be made to the Director.
- Information will only be released to persons outside TBCC with the express written consent of the employee.

Confidentiality Related to Proprietary Information

Zahra Daycare Ltd has developed unique techniques, curricula, and tools for evaluation which make our program more competitive in the industry and are not to be revealed to sources outside of the company. Anything which the company designs, produces, implements, and markets is treated as proprietary information. This includes, but is not be limited to, the Center's family list, employee list, curriculum, philosophy, mission statement, personnel policies, and employee/parent handbooks.

No employee should discuss proprietary information with other employees in any public place where such information could be overheard. Employees should also not provide others with any documents relating to this propriety information. Employees must understand that it is not only their duty to protect Zahra Daycare Ltd's proprietary information during their term of employment, but that this legal obligation continues even after separation from

employment. Employees are required to return any and all documentation that contains proprietary information at the time of separation. This obligation may be enforced through court action, if necessary.

Violation of Confidentiality Policy

Any employee/volunteer who violates the Confidentiality Policy will be subject to disciplinary action including termination. In addition to job-related consequences, the employee/volunteer may face possible civil liability for their actions.

WORK SCHEDULE

Zahra Daycare Ltd is open Monday through Friday from 7am until 6pm. Work schedules are prepared by the Director each week and will be posted on Friday, with hours set for the following week. The schedule will include work days, work hours, and days off.

Hours of attendance have been carefully planned and employees are required to work the hours and days for which they have been scheduled. If you are unable to report to work for any reason, you must notify the Director/Assistant Director at least 4 hours prior to your scheduled starting time. Failure to provide notice in a timely manner will be considered unexcused absence and may result in disciplinary action. Employees will not be permitted to use available leave time for an unexcused absence. Employees who fail to notify the Director/Assistant Director at all may be considered to have abandoned their position, which will result in termination.

HEALTH SCREENING

As you will be working with children, your physical health is very important! Staff must be free of physical and psychological conditions which might adversely affect the physical, mental, or emotional health of the children under their care.

In some situations, additional health appraisals may be required to provide documentation for reasonable accommodations of an employee's disability or to determine eligibility for leave.

If health changes occur during employment which may impact the ability of a staff member to perform the requisite duties of the position, or which may endanger or otherwise adversely affect others at the Center, an outside expert may be consulted to determine a staff member's condition and its potential impact on children at the Center.

STAFF SCREENING

Just as your individual health is important to the Center, other personal factors which may affect the safety and health of the children in your care or of other individuals at the Center must be assessed as well. The following items must be completed prior to employment:

The staff at Zahra Daycare Ltd is composed of qualified caregivers as required by Provincial Qualifications. The Director holds a Diploma in Early Childhood Education, Level 111 Child Development Supervisor Certification,

All other staff have level 1 certificates in Early Childhood Development or higher. They have Police and Security Checks including the Vulnerable Sector (child related offences) which are renewed every three

years. Staff is also required to have updated training in Child Care CPR & First Aid. All permanent child care staff maintains an up-to-date Child Care First Aide & CPR certificate.

ILLNESS

If you are ill, please contact the Director at least 4 hours in advance to ensure that we are able to provide adequate coverage to meet state ratio requirements. In general, staff that provides adequate notice will not be required to provide documentation (doctor's note, etc.) for the first day of absence. Providing less than 4 hours' notice or having an illness which lasts more than a day may require official documentation in order to validate the absence and permit the employee to return to work.

PAY SCHEDULE

Employees will be paid Monthly basis, and Paycheques will be distributed on the first day of each month.

Employees must record in and out to accurately record the actual hours worked. Employees who falsely represent the number of hours worked or those who fail to record in and out correctly may have their paycheck delayed and may be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination.

When a payday falls on a holiday, paychecks will be issued on the next business day after the holiday.

VACATIONS

Both full-time and part-time employees shall be eligible for vacation time payment, calculated as 4% of your total wage and will be paid monthly with your pay cheque.

EMPLOYEE BENEFITS

Zahra Daycare Ltd is a small, family-oriented daycare. We do strive to provide additional benefits to employees whenever possible, based on funding.

Benefits' eligibility is generally determined by an employee's classification. Employees are classified as either full-time or part-time for the purpose of determining applicable benefits.

Employees will generally be classified upon hiring; reclassification may be done at the Director's discretion, based on changes to an employee's overall hours worked or other appropriate circumstances. Each employee will be advised at the time of hire of the benefits for which they are eligible. Employees will be notified of additional benefits and their eligibility during the course of employment.

We currently offer the following benefits to employees. Some are immediately available when an employee starts work; others depend on the length of employment at the Center.

Child Care

Zahra Daycare Ltd allows employees to enroll their minor children in the program at the employee (discounted) rate, as noted on our child care fees schedule. Employees seeking to enroll their child(ren) in the program must discuss placement and tuition benefits with the Director.

Under most circumstances, an employee who has a child enrolled in the Center will be prohibited from providing direct care to her or his child.

Employees who fail to pay tuition according to the Fee Agreement will have their child care services terminated/suspended, just as any other parent would.

Zahra Daycare Ltd further reserves the right to disenroll an employee's child(ren) if the employee's performance is affected by having his or her child(ren) at the Center. Employees must remember they are employed to perform a specific job and not allow themselves to be distracted by having their child(ren) enrolled in the program. Employees are prohibited from interfering with the supervision or authority of their child(ren)'s classroom teacher.

Non-enrolled minor children of employees are generally prohibited from being on Center property without an accompanying adult while the employee is on the clock, except with the prior written approval of the Director or when the employee's family is invited to participate in Center activities.

Evaluation and Advancement

Reviews of an employee's work are important to help determine advancement at the Center and an employee's suitability

for continued employment. Provisional employees are evaluated at the 90-day mark; employees who successfully complete the provisional employment period are then evaluated annually thereafter, on or near the anniversary of the first day of employment.

The purpose of each evaluation is to determine an employee's overall fitness for the job, the assigned duties, and the Center as a whole. They are intended to be a positive experience for the employee and the Director/Assistant Director. Each evaluation will assess the entire period of employment since the employee's previous appraisal.

Evaluations not only look back on an employee's performance, but also look forward by establishing short-term and long-term goals for the employee. Goals should serve both the needs of the Center and the employee, allowing both to grow. Progress toward reaching those goals may be used in an employee's annual evaluation.

During the evaluation, the Director/Assistant Director will go over the evaluation with the employee, discussing the employee's accomplishments, progress, and any areas of concern. The employee will be expected to sign the evaluation to indicate discussion and receipt of a copy of the evaluation. Note that signing the evaluation does not mean that the employee agrees with every item listed or discussed; in the case of an employee's disagreement with the appraisal, written comments from the employee may be attached to document the employee's objections to particular items (or the evaluation as a whole), as well as provide the employee's rebuttal to specific items.

If an employee refuses to sign the evaluation, another employee must witness the refusal by signing a statement verifying the refusal. The employee being evaluated will provide a written statement of her reasons for not providing a signature.

All employees will receive a copy of their annual evaluations and goals determined for the upcoming year. The original, signed evaluation will be placed in the employee's personnel record.

Materials related to the evaluation process may be obtained from the Director upon request.

PERSONNEL RECORDS

A confidential file will be maintained on each employee containing all employment-related documents such as the employment application, résumé, job and salary history, performance appraisals, disciplinary action, general correspondence, and other documents that pertain to employment at Zahra Daycare Ltd. To comply with the Americans with Disabilities Act, ZDL keeps all medically-related information in a separate confidential file.

Any false statements made by employees on their employment applications or personnel records will result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

An employee may have SUPERVISED access to her or his file during normal business hours upon request to the Director. Personnel files may not be removed from the office. Employees are prohibited from removing any documents from their personnel file. Employees may only add documentation to their personnel file with the permission of the Director.

Employee requests for copies of the documents contained in the personnel file must be made in writing to the Director. Employees will be charged \$1.00 per page for photocopying.

REQUIRED STAFF MEETINGS

Because communication between the staff and the Director/Assistant Director is crucial to good practices within the Center, mandatory staff meetings will be scheduled on a monthly basis. All employees are expected to attend these meetings; exceptions must be approved in writing by the Director, in advance of the meeting.

All staff meetings will be announced in advance and generally will occur after the Center has closed for the day. Employees will be compensated at their normal hourly pay rate for the meeting.

REVIEW OF POLICIES AND PROCEDURES

An invitation shall be extended to staff and families to participate in the review of centre policies and procedures. A committee shall be formed with the interested parties. The committee shall meet annually prior to September 30 to review all policies and procedures. Any recommended changes shall be shared with other families and staff members via email. If there are no objections within 5 business days, the committee may proceed with the changes. Document the new policy or procedure with a date of amendment.

If a family objects to the change in policy or procedure, they may meet with the committee. All efforts will be made to satisfy all parties involved.

GENERAL INTERACTIONS

In general, employees need to maintain a sense of decorum when interacting with others at the Center and observe general rules of proper conduct. Staffs are expected to act in a caring, honest, respectful, and responsible manner consistent with Zahra Daycare Ltd's mission statement. Staff should always portray a positive role model by maintaining an attitude of loyalty, patience, courtesy, tact, and maturity.

This includes things like:

- Refraining from intimate displays of affection towards others in the presence of children, parents, and other staff.
- Prohibiting profanity, inappropriate jokes, sharing intimate personal details, or any kind of harassment in the presence of children, parents, or other staff.

Staffs are required to report any violations by other staff members of these or other policies listed in the handbook to the Director for possible action. Such reporting is confidential.

Co-worker Interaction

While our employees are encouraged to develop professional and personal connections with one another, gossiping, spreading rumors, and other similar types of negative behavior are discouraged. Gossip which could affect the ability of the Center or staff to conduct business, maintain good community or employee relations, or otherwise impact Zahra Daycare Ltd in a negative way may result in disciplinary action for the employee who has engaged in the conduct.

Families

Families (the children whom we serve, and their parents, guardians, and other family members) are our Center's most valuable asset. Every employee represents Zahra Daycare Ltd to our families and to the public. The manner in which we do our jobs presents an image of our entire organization. Families judge all of us by how they are treated by each and every employee. Nothing is more important than being, respectful, courteous, friendly, helpful, and prompt in the attention given to families.

Our personal contact with the public, our manners on the telephone, and the communications we send to families are a reflection not only of ourselves, but also of the professionalism of Zahra Daycare Ltd. Positive interactions with our families not only enhance the public's perception or image of ZDL, but also help us to obtain grants and contracts.

It is expected that all employees of Zahra Daycare Ltd will interact respectfully, courteously, and promptly with our families.

All of the families have the right to their privacy. Do not discuss the children and families publicly or with family members, either by name or physical description. Some of the families have also restricted photography permission for their children; please refer to the Social Media policy listed in this section for more information.

Employees who fail to have appropriate interactions with our families will be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

Children

While many of the specific policies governing interaction with the children under our care are in the section of the

handbook dealing Classroom and Curriculum, some general principles are as follows:

- Children have a right to be spoken to with respect. Staff should listen to what the children have to say, and respond to the children with respect and consideration.
- Children have a right to be cared about without prejudice. Staff will treat all children equally regardless of sex, race, religion, culture, economic status, or disability.
- Children have a right not to be yelled at or humiliated. Staff will maintain conversational voice levels and should not single out children for exclusion or in a manner which might otherwise overly embarrass the child.
- Children have a right not to be hurt. Staff will maintain a safe environment for the children, and will see to their safety. Staff should intervene to help a child avoid a dangerous or otherwise hurtful situation whenever possible.
- Children have a right to their own privacy. Staff will respect the rights of children to not be touched or looked at in ways which may make the children uncomfortable, and respect the children's right to say no. Other than diapering, children are not to be touched on areas of their bodies that would be covered by a bathing suit.

SOCIAL MEDIA POLICY

Employees must consider and respect the privacy of the children, families, staff, and administrators of the Center in all online activity. The posting of confidential and/or identifying information about the children, families, or other staff members at the Center on social media (including but not limited to Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, and so forth) is strictly prohibited. In no way does the Center wish to abridge the rights of its employees to engage in critical commentary and observations that may relate to the Center and its operations; however, when such commentary and observations occur within a public forum and contain confidential information, it may result in disciplinary action for the employee.

The posting of non-confidential information (promotional materials and the like) shall be restricted to official channels of communication (the Center's website/Facebook page, etc.) unless prior written approval from the Director has been obtained.

EMPLOYEE ABUSE POLICY AND PROCEDURES

The purpose of the policy is:

- a) To maintain an environment that is free from harassment or abuse.
- b) To identify the behaviours those are unacceptable.
- c) To establish a mechanism for receiving complaints.
- d) To establish a procedure to deal with complaints.

1.) Policy Statement

The organization will not tolerate any form of physical, sexual, emotional, verbal, or psychological abuse, or any form of neglect or harassment.

2.) Definitions

Physical Abuse is defined as but not limited to the use of intentional force that can result in physical harm or injury to an individual. It can take the form of slapping, hitting, punching, shaking, pulling, throwing, kicking, biting, choking, strangling or the abusive use of restraints.

Sexual Abuse is defined as but not limited to any unwanted touching, fondling, observations for sexual gratification, any penetration or attempted penetration with a penis, digital or object of the vagina or anus, verbal or written propositions or innuendos, exhibitionism or exploitation for profit including pornography.

Emotional Abuse is defined as but not limited to a chronic attack on an individual's self-esteem. It can take the form of name calling, threatening, ridiculing, berating, intimidating, isolating, hazing, habitual scapegoat, blaming.

Verbal Abuse is defined as but not limited to humiliating remarks, name calling, swearing at, taunting, teasing, continual put downs.

Psychological Abuse is defined as but not limited to communication of an abusive nature, sarcasm, exploitive behaviour, intimidation, manipulation, and insensitivity to race, sexual preference or family dynamics.

Neglect is defined as but not limited to any behaviour that leads to a failure to provide services which are necessary such as withdrawing basic necessities as forms of punishment, failing to assess and respond to changes in health status and refusing or withdrawing physical or emotional support.

Harassment is defined as but not limited to any unwanted physical or verbal conduct that offends or humiliates, including gender-based harassment. It can be a single incident or several incidents over time. It includes threats, intimidation, display of racism, sexism, unnecessary physical contact, suggestive remarks or gestures, offensive pictures or jokes. Harassment will be considered to have taken place if a reasonable person ought to have known that the behaviour was unwelcome.

3.) Governing Legislation

Child and Family Services Authorities Act, RSA 2000, c C-11

Alberta Human Rights Act, RSA 2000, c A-25.5

Criminal Code of Canada, RSC 1985, c C-46

Nursing Homes Act, RSA 2000, c N7

Health Professions Act, RSA 2000, c H7

4.) Who is covered by this Policy?

This will include all employees, volunteers, visitors, parents, independent contractors, etc.

5.) Abuse Reporting Procedures

Albertans can now report abuse and receive support, information and referrals through a new centralized phone line

If people suspect someone is being abused or neglected, they can get help by calling the Alberta Supports abuse line at 1-855-4HELPAB (4435722).

The phone line includes new staff training and protocols, such as an abuse response procedure to help ensure a coordinated provincial response to callers. All calls will be tracked to ensure Albertans receive the supports they need.

6.) Obligations of work site parties

As part of the changing roles of individuals at the work site, employers, supervisors and workers have specific duties they must follow to address harassment and violence at the workplace.

- **Employers** must ensure workers are not subject to or participate in harassment or violence at the work site.
- **Supervisors** must ensure workers under their supervision are not subject to harassment or violence at the work site.
- **Workers** must refrain from causing or participating in harassment or violence.

Hazard assessment

Harassment and violence are workplace hazards and must be addressed during a hazard assessment.

The hazard assessment and control process is a documented approach to prevent work-related illness or injury. It identifies situations that could put workers at risk for harassment or violence in the workplace. By recognizing these real and potential hazards, employers can take steps to eliminate or control them to prevent harm to workers.

Prevention plans

Policies set overall expectations that harassment and violence are not tolerated in the work environment.

Procedures outline the methods or processes required to make the policy work on a day-to-day basis and establish a way of doing things that the employer and workers are to follow.

Review of plans

The plans must be reviewed every 3 years or more often if there is an incident of harassment or violence or if the health and safety committee or representative requests a review.

The review should focus on whether the policy or procedures are current and if there are any deficiencies or gaps that need to be addressed.

Worker training

Employers must instruct workers on:

- the hazard of workplace harassment and violence
- how to recognize the signs of danger
- what to do about it
- how to report it

Investigating and reporting incidents

Employers will:

- investigate any incident of harassment or violence
- take action to address the incident
- prevent it from happening again
- prepare an investigation report outlining the circumstances of the incident and the corrective action

Employers must retain the investigation report for at least 2 years after the incident, keep it readily available and provide a copy to Alberta OHS on request.

An Alberta OHS officer may also conduct an investigation of the incident and may conduct interviews and gather evidence to determine what happened. Work site parties are required to cooperate with the officer.

Worker support

Employers must offer support to workers who are affected by an incident of harassment or violence in the workplace.

Affected workers will be advised to consult a health professional (of the worker's choice) for treatment or referral. Workers should consider accessing services and resources through an employee assistance program, if one exists.

CONFLICT RESOLUTION

Conflicts can arise between employees, employees and families, and the like. In the event that two or more parties find themselves in a situation where conflict is inevitable or has already occurred, has affected or will affect the Center and its operation, and can be potentially resolved through the actions of the Center, procedures have been established to ensure that all parties to any conflict receive fair and equal hearing to help resolve the circumstances surrounding the issue. (Terminated/Former Employees are not eligible to participate in the Conflict Resolution process.)

This process is as follows:

- The employee/petitioner must submit a written statement to the Director/Assistant Director within 5 working days of the employee's knowledge of the event which caused the conflict.
- The Director/Assistant Director shall attempt to resolve the conflict within 5 working days following receipt of the statement and issue a written decision. A copy of the decision will be provided to the petitioner.
- If the employee/petitioner is not satisfied, or if the conflict is with the Director/Assistant Director, the employee/petitioner may appeal the decision within 5 working days to an ad hoc committee composed of Advisory Board members.
- The ad hoc committee will meet within 5 working days to review the employee/petitioner's written statement regarding the conflict. The ad hoc committee will set the date and time of the meeting and will invite the employee/petitioner to attend. If the employee cannot attend, the ad hoc committee will make one good faith attempt to reschedule the meeting so the employee may be present. However, the employee's presence at the ad hoc committee meeting is not required to issue a decision.
- The aggrieved employee shall be permitted to be present at the meeting of the ad hoc committee. The employee has the right to be represented by an attorney. The committee has a right to require appropriate employees to present relevant information.
- The Conflict Resolution Committee will submit its written recommendation to the Director at the next scheduled meeting. Upon review of the recommendation the Director will issue a final decision.
- The employee will be notified in writing of the final decision of the Director within 5 days following the last decision-making body's meeting. This decision of the Director is final and binding.

DISCIPLINARY PROCESS

In the event that an employee is found to be in violation of one or more policies outlined in this handbook, the disciplinary process may be initiated. While this is generally a process of escalating actions, certain violations may be more egregious in their severity, frequency of occurrence, and/or scope, and thus could warrant a disciplinary action higher on the list, up to and including termination of duties. The determination of the specific disciplinary action to be undertaken is at the discretion of the Director, and will be appropriate to the nature of the offense.

Reprimand

A reprimand may be given to any employee when a minor violation of Center policies or procedures has occurred. A reprimand may be either verbal or written. Verbal reprimands will be documented by the Director/Assistant Director, and the documentation will be placed in the employee's personnel file. Written reprimands will include brief documentation of the incident and the date on which it occurred. Written reprimands require that a copy of the written reprimand be given to the employee, and a copy of the reprimand signed by the employee to acknowledge receipt of the document must be placed in the employee's file.

Written Warning

For more serious violations of policies and procedures, or repeated minor violations, an employee may be given a written warning. The written warning will clearly describe the deficiency in the performance or conduct, and will cite the policy, licensing regulation, or procedure violated. The written warning will contain a corrective action plan, outlining the necessary action(s) to correct the deficiency and a timetable in which the corrective action must occur.

A copy of the written warning and the corrective action plan will be given to the employee. Employees are required to sign a copy of the written warning, acknowledging its receipt, which will then be placed in the employee's personnel file. Signing the written warning does not indicate that the employee agrees with the contents; it simply indicates receipt of a copy of the written warning. Failure or refusal to sign the written warning will be considered insubordination and will result in disciplinary action up to and including termination.

Copies of all documentation regarding corrective action plans will be retained by the Director.

Investigatory Suspension

For suspected severe, but unconfirmed allegations of policy and procedure violations, the Director may initiate an Investigatory Suspension of the employee. During this time, the employee is suspended without pay. The outcome of an investigatory suspension is generally

either full reinstatement (if the employee is found not to be in violation of the policies) or further disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

Examples of situations which would warrant use of Investigatory suspension include, but are not limited to: Charges of driving while intoxicated

- Report of child abuse or neglect
- Accusations of theft
- Violation of the Substance Abuse Policy
- Other similar situations

Investigatory suspension may not exceed 10 working days without the approval of the Director.

SUSPENSION

Suspension of an employee may occur at the discretion of the Director/Assistant Director for specific, major infractions of the Personnel Policies. Suspension of an employee will not require prior verbal or written disciplinary action.

Suspension may be used in circumstances where a confirmed violation of policies is not considered severe enough to warrant termination of employment, and where the employee can be successfully rehabilitated to effectively discharge the duties of the position. Possible violations are similar to those on both the list for Investigatory Suspension and Termination, though certain violations are still subject to immediate termination of employment, without recourse to an initial suspension. Each situation is different, and will be treated as such.

Suspension will be without pay. The employee will be notified in writing of the specific charges and the length of the suspension, and will be provided with a copy of this notice. The employee is required to sign a copy of the suspension notification to acknowledge receipt of same. Failure to sign the suspension notification will be considered insubordination and will result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

When circumstances permit, an employee will be suspended upon receipt of the suspension notification. However, an employee may be suspended verbally if immediate suspension is in the best interest of Zahra Daycare Ltd, its employees, or the children under the Center's care. Written notification in these circumstances will promptly follow via certified mail.

Suspension by verbal notice may be given by the Director/Assistant Director, followed immediately by written approval of the Director.

TERMINATION

Involuntary termination does not necessarily require prior verbal or written disciplinary action. Zahra Daycare Ltd, in accordance with labor standards, is an "at-will" employer and may terminate the employment relationship at any time with or without cause and without notice. This policy is to be used as a guide for employees, but is not inclusive of all possible reasons or causes for termination from employment. Termination is an action which must be approved by the Director. Notification of Termination may be written or verbal.

Causes for involuntary termination include, but are not limited to, the following:

- Unsatisfactory provisional period
 - Falsifying or misusing records, including application
 - Violation of confidentiality rules
 - Theft or misuse of Zahra Daycare Ltd funds, equipment, or property
 - Absence from work without notification and/or approval as per related policies
 - Discourteous treatment of the public, families, or co-workers
 - Inappropriate behavior
 - Non-performance of duties resulting in injury to the Center, its children, families, or employees.
 - Being abusive or neglectful to children, parents, or employees
 - Violation of the Substance Abuse Policy
 - Failure to submit required documentation within mandated time frame
 - Neglect of duty or refusal to comply with directives of Director/Assistant Director
 - Misuse of leave policies

- Insubordination
- Receipt of 2 suspensions for the same infraction during any 12 month period.
- Failure to implement job specifics
- Receipt of 3 written warnings for any violations during any 12 month period; the date of the third warning will be the employee's last day of employment
- Failure to return to work following a leave of absence
- Failure to meet deadlines as presented by Director/Assistant Director

Employees who are involuntarily terminated shall forfeit all accrued vacation time and other benefits. Once employment has been terminated under this action, the employee is expected to return any keys and other property of the Center to the Director, and leave the Center at that time. The former employee will be escorted out of the building, and is no longer permitted on Zahra Daycare Ltd property without the written approval of the Director. Any of the former employee's personal property or effects which remain at Center will be packed and shipped to the former employee's home address. The former employee's final paycheck(s) will be mailed to that address as well, and may not be picked up at the Center. All final paychecks will be sent on the scheduled paydays for the pay period applicable for the hours worked.

RESIGNATION

Although we want every employee to stay with us for as long as possible, sometimes new opportunities arise that an employee may wish to explore. While we do not wish to hinder our employees from pursuing these endeavors, we also ask that our employees provide ample opportunity for us to seek suitable replacements for the departing employee. As such, employees are required to give two (2) weeks' notice of the intention to terminate employment. Notice must be given in writing to the Director. If submitted by any other method other than directly to the Director, the two week period begins upon receipt of the notice by the Director, not when the notice was mailed or otherwise sent. As noted in the Benefits section, unused vacation time may not be used as part of the required two weeks' notice.

Employees who give the required notice will be entitled to payment of accumulated vacation time, provided all Center equipment and property has been returned. Employees who fail to give the required notice will forfeit payment for any accrued, unused vacation time.

In general, an employee's final paycheck(s) will be sent to the home address listed in the employee's file on the regularly scheduled pay dates for the hours worked.

EMPLOYMENT REFERENCES

Zahra Daycare Ltd will release information regarding positions held and length of employment for reference purposes. In order to release any additional information regarding employment, the employee must provide a signed release. Confidential information will only be provided with the employee's express written permission. All requests for references must be in writing.

Unless specifically authorized by the Director, employees are strictly prohibited from providing references for any employee under any circumstance, including a personal reference.

WELCOME! WE LOOK FORWARD TO A LONG, SUCCESSFUL PARTNERSHIP WITH YOU!

ATTACH EMPLOYEE ORIENTATION CHECKLIST